



... and back

Those that take blood back to your heart are called veins.



A drop of blood goes around your body more than a thousand times a day. Every five minutes all your blood passes through your kidneys to be cleaned.

Super cells

In one tiny drop of blood there are red cells, white cells, and platelets, all floating in a liquid called plasma. The blood in your arteries is carrying more oxygen, which makes it a brighter red color than the blood in your veins.

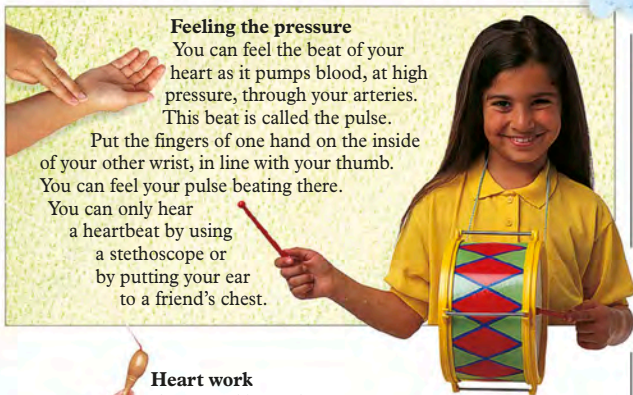


Feeling the pressure

You can feel the beat of your heart as it pumps blood, at high pressure, through your arteries. This beat is called the pulse.

Put the fingers of one hand on the inside of your other wrist, in line with your thumb. You can feel your pulse beating there.

You can only hear a heartbeat by using a stethoscope or by putting your ear to a friend's chest.



Heart work

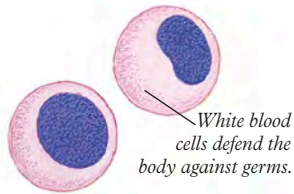
When you skip, or do any kind of exercise, your muscles need extra oxygen and food from your blood. To provide this, your heart has to pump faster.

You have nearly one gallon (about four liters) of blood in your body. An adult has more and a baby has less.

Side view of a red blood cell



Red cells carry oxygen around the body. They are made in the bone marrow.



White blood cells defend the body against germs.

If you cut yourself, platelets rush to the broken blood vessel and stick themselves together to plug the cut.

